

Man and Superman



Nietzsche proposed that the world we live in is the only reality, and is both godless and aimless. But instead of being horrified and rejecting the world, he believed we should reject the old philosophies and religions and their value systems in order to live our lives to the full. The virtues praised by classical Greek philosophers, and later especially by Christianity, he argued, hold us back from achieving our true potential. We are free to choose the values that are best for us, and should be extolling virtues such as strength and ability rather than humility, which keep us as slaves to a religious value system. By ‘daring to become what you are’, Nietzsche suggested we can

free ourselves from this slave morality to go beyond good and evil, and judge the morality of our actions by whether they are life-asserting or not. This 'will to power' also allows the emergence of the gifted individual and potential leader, who Nietzsche describes as an *Übermensch*, or 'Superman'. As the eponymous hero of his *Thus Spoke Zarathustra* says: 'Man is something to be surpassed.'